

Chapter 193

Blackmagic Cloud Presentations

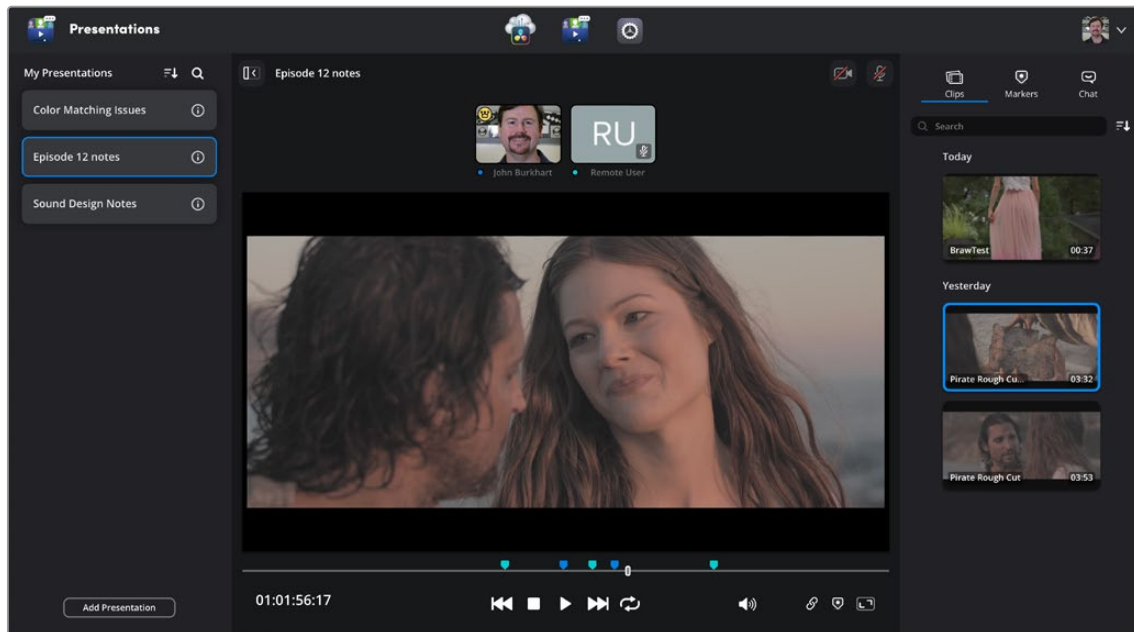
This chapter describes how to use the Presentations application in the Blackmagic Cloud, allowing you to setup review and collaboration sessions online with people from around the world.

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Blackmagic Presentations

The Presentations application in Blackmagic Cloud allows real time collaboration and review of DaVinci Resolve timelines using only an internet browser. Collaboration tools consist of video conferencing for real time communication, a chat interface for persistent notes and comments, and markers that sync directly with a DaVinci Resolve timeline. With these tools, you can play back a video with frame accurate sync for all users, while video conferencing at the same time.



The Blackmagic Presentations application in a web browser

The Presentations application is comprised of three parts. The left column is My Presentations, where all your different presentations are created, stored, and organized. The center area is the Viewer that lets you navigate the clip, add markers, and adjust the audio playback. On top of the Viewer is the Video Conferencing area, allowing you to collaborate in real time with other members. The right column is divided into three sections: Clips, Markers, and Chat. Clips show all the available clips to comment and collaborate on. Markers will show a list of markers and comments that sync with a DaVinci Resolve timeline. Chat opens up a simple chat interface to have a record of your notes and comments.

NOTE: As of this writing, Presentations is still in beta. As beta software, the features described below may be changed, redesigned, or removed completely from the final release.

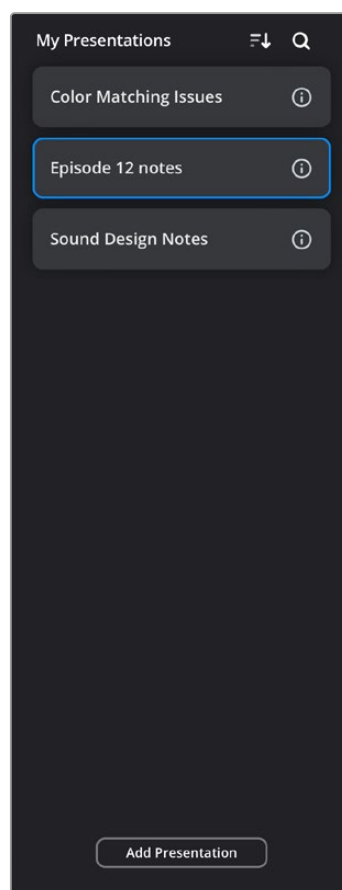
Creating and Managing Presentations

Online collaboration in Presentations is comprised of two parts: first, the Presentation in the Blackmagic Cloud and secondly, a timeline from a DaVinci Resolve workstation (described below). This section describes the creation and management of Presentations.

NOTE: Presentations uses a slightly different nomenclature describing clips than DaVinci Resolve. In Presentations, a “clip” is a DaVinci Resolve “timeline,” and not a clip that you would find in the Media Pool.

Creating a New Presentation

Each presentation can be thought of like a project in DaVinci Resolve, except that it’s about discussion rather than post production. Presentations contain multiple “clips” to review and have a variety of collaboration tools, rather than editing/color/fx/audio tools. While making a new presentation for each project is perfectly valid, you can also make presentations based off other criteria, like who is collaborating, a date, or a specific stage of the post production process.



The My Presentations column

To Create a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

- 1 Log into your Blackmagic Cloud account in a web browser at www.blackmagicdesign.com.
- 2 Select the Presentations icon in the upper center of the web page.
- 3 In the My Presentations column, click on the Add Presentation button in the lower left.
- 4 Select a Name for the presentation and click Add.
- 5 Click on the Presentation in the My Presentations column to launch it.

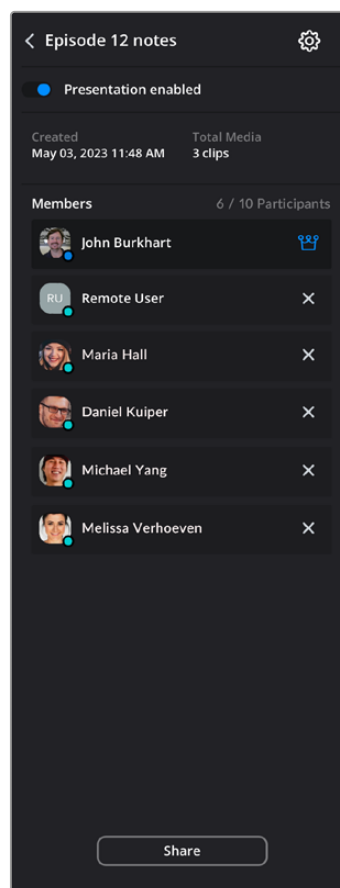
If you find you have more presentations than can fit on the screen, the My Presentations column can be sorted by name and date in ascending or descending order by clicking on the sort icon just to the right.

The My Presentations column is also searchable by clicking on the magnifying glass to the right and entering your search terms. Only presentations matching your search terms will be shown.

Until you upload your first clip from a DaVinci Resolve project, the Viewer will show “Upload clips from DaVinci Resolve to get started.” That process is described below in the “Sending a Timeline to Presentations” section.

Sharing a Presentation with Another User

You can share a presentation with up to 10 other users. The only requirement is that each user has their own Blackmagic Cloud account.



The information panel of a presentation

To Share a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

- 1 Click on the information icon (the circled letter i) next to the presentation name. A Members pane is exposed, showing all the current users that the presentation is shared with. The user with the crown icon is the presentation administrator, and only they can add or remove users.
- 2 Click on the Share button at the bottom of the Members pane.
- 3 Enter the email address (used to create the Blackmagic Cloud account) of the user you wish to share the presentation with.
- 4 Click on the Share button.

The user's name will now appear in the Members pane, and the presentation will show up in their own My Presentations column when logging into the Blackmagic Cloud. They can now watch any clips, video conference, or make comments in that presentation.

Additionally, an email will be sent to the user's email address, notifying them of the presentation and a direct link to access it.

To remove a user from a presentation, simply click on the "x" next to their name in the Members panel. Only the administrator can add or remove members.

Enabling and Disabling a Presentation

The administrator can choose to temporarily disable a presentation. This is used to temporarily lock access to the presentation without deleting it. This keeps all the clips, users, and comments in place and only prevents the presentation being viewed or modified until it's enabled again.

To Enable or Disable a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

- 1 Click on the Information icon (the circled letter i) next to the presentation name.
- 2 Click on the Presentation enabled switch directly below the presentation name to toggle between enabling and disabling the presentation.

Renaming a Presentation

The administrator can easily rename a presentation to more accurately describe its purpose or contents.

To Rename a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

- 1 Click on the Information icon (the circled letter i) next to the presentation name.
- 2 Click on the Settings icon (the small gear) next to the presentation name.
- 3 Select Rename from the drop-down menu.
- 4 Type in the new name for the presentation.
- 5 Click on the Save button.

The presentation's name will be then updated in the My Presentations column for all users.

Deleting a Presentation

When you've finished with a presentation, the administrator can delete it from the Blackmagic Cloud. A deleted presentation permanently removes all clips and comments and is not undoable, so make sure you are completely finished before you delete it.

To Delete a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

- 1 Click on the Information icon (the circled letter i) next to the presentation name.
- 2 Click on the Settings icon (the small gear) next to the presentation name.
- 3 Select Delete from the drop-down menu.
- 4 Click on the Delete button in the warning dialog box.

Leaving a Presentation

As a user you can leave a Presentation at any time. This removes permission for you to view and edit the presentation, and removes it from your My Presentations column. If you wish to gain access to a presentation again once you've left, the presentation administrator must re-share it with you.

To Leave a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

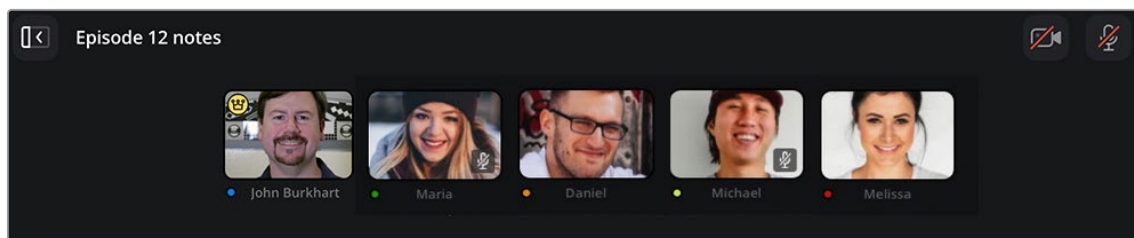
- 1 Click on the Information icon (the circled letter i) next to the presentation name.
- 2 Click on the Settings icon (the small gear) next to the presentation name.
- 3 Select Leave from the drop-down menu.
- 4 Click on the Leave button in the warning dialog box.

Using Presentations

The heart of Presentations is the Viewer; here you can both video conference and control the playback of a clip. The Viewer provides a low latency, streaming video that you can use to accurately mark and comment on, as those comments show up in real time to other users and on the DaVinci Resolve timeline.

Video Conferencing

The top strip of the Viewer contains a basic video conferencing interface, with each user's video stream appearing in a live thumbnail. By default the camera and microphone are turned off, so you will need to switch them on manually.



The video conferencing interface; note the Camera and Microphone on/off controls in the upper right.

To Turn On and Off the Camera and Microphone for a Blackmagic Cloud Presentation

- 1 Click on the Camera and/or Microphone icons in the upper right of the Viewer.
- 2 Give your OS and browser appropriate permissions to use the devices.
- 3 To turn off the Camera and Microphone, click their respective icons again.

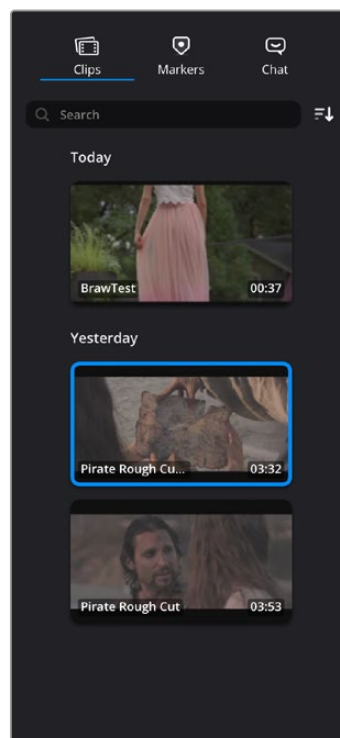
With your camera and microphone on, all other connected users will see and hear you through their web browsers, so be generous and discrete with your comments.

Controlling a Clip in the Viewer

Each user can view and comment on any of the clips (including the same clip) in real time. The Viewer for each user is independent of all the others, though the administrator has the option to sync everyone's Viewer to their own, in order to watch the same clip at the same time.

Selecting a Clip

Selecting a clip to view is as easy as clicking on the clip's thumbnail in the Clips column. Clips are sortable by date, duration, and name in ascending or descending order. The Clips column is also searchable by clicking on the magnifying glass to the right and entering your search terms. Only clips matching your search terms will be shown. You can also hover your pointer over the clip thumbnail to scrub through the video.



The Clips column

Administrators can edit the names, and delete clips from the presentation by hovering over the thumbnail and selecting the appropriate icons (pencil and trashcan) in the upper right.

Viewer Controls

The Presentations Viewer has a set of playback controls at the bottom of the browser that you can use to position your playhead exactly.



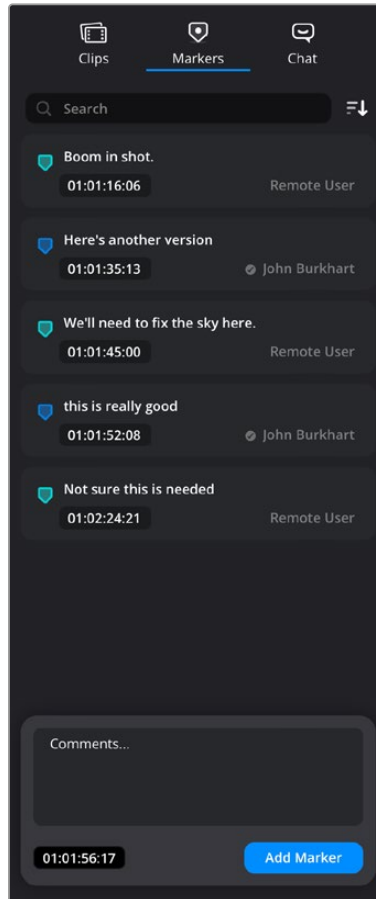
The Viewer controls

	Jog Bar: The long line across the bottom of the browser shows your current playhead position as a rectangle and any markers that have been set. You can click and drag the playhead to scrub back and forth in the clip.
	Timecode: The timecode of the current clip that refers back to the original DaVinci Resolve timeline.
	Previous Clip: (Up Arrow) Loads the clip above the current clip in the Clips column into the Viewer. If the current clip is already at the top of the stack, it will wrap around to the clip at the bottom.
	Stop: Stops playback of the clip in the Viewer.
	Play: Plays the clip in the Viewer forward at 1x speed.
	Next Clip: (Down Arrow) Loads the clip below the current clip in the Clips column into the Viewer. If the current clip is already at the bottom of the stack, it will wrap around to the clip at the top.
	Loop: Toggles between no looping (the default), Loop One which will loop the current clip over and over, and Loop All which will play back all the clips in the Clips column and loop back to the beginning of the stack.
	Volume: Clicking on this icon mutes the audio. Dragging the slider next to the icon controls the volume of the clip.
	Start Sync: (Administrator only), clicking this icon allows the contents of your Viewer to display for all members. The administrator's view overrides the Viewers of all the other users, ensuring that everyone is watching the same thing at the same time.
	Add Marker: Clicking this icon adds a marker at the playhead position. Editing and commenting on this marker is done in the Markers column described below.
	Full Screen: This expands the Viewer to take up the entire screen.

NOTE: You can move the playhead frame by frame forward and back by using the left and right arrow keys respectively.

Using Markers

There are three ways to make your opinion known on a clip in Presentations. The first is speaking directly through video conferencing as described above, the second and third are through markers and chat.



The Markers column

Markers allow you to make written comments attached to a specific frame of video. This lets you give targeted advice exactly where it needs to be. The main benefit of using markers is that they also immediately transfer to the DaVinci Resolve timeline used to make the clip. This ensures that your comments make it back to the editor/colorist/audio engineer as they work on the project.

To Add a Marker to a Clip at the Playhead Position, do one of the following:

- Click on the Add Marker icon in the Viewer.
- Tap the letter M on your keyboard.
- In the Markers column, write your comment in the text box at the bottom, and click on the Add Marker button.

Markers will show up as a triangle that is the same color as the colored dot associated with the user's thumbnail in the Video Conferencing pane.

To Edit the Text Contents of a Marker:

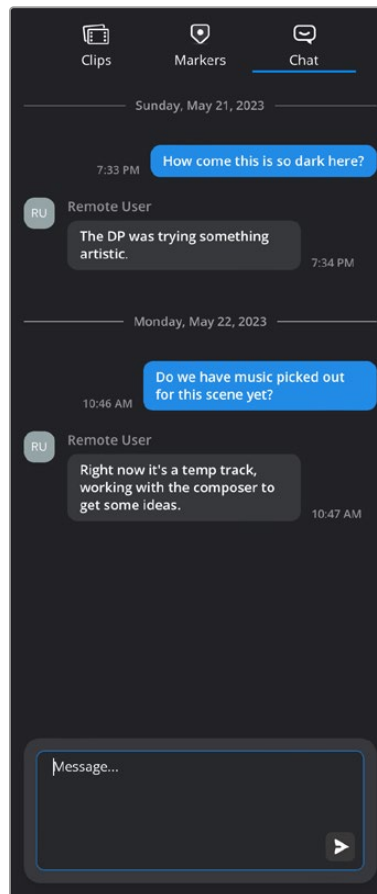
- 1 Hover over the marker in the Markers column, and tap on the Pencil icon.
- 2 Write your comment in the text box.
- 3 Click on save.

To Delete a Marker from a Clip:

- 1 Hover over the marker in the Markers column, and tap on the Trashcan icon.
- 2 Click on Delete in the warning dialog.

Using Chat

The Chat column gives you a simple text-based conversation tool that is persistently saved. This lets you leave notes, comments, and refer back to previous sessions if necessary. The Chat column is not tied to any specific clip but to the presentation as a whole.



The Chat column

To Leave a Chat Comment:

- 1 Write your message in the text box at the bottom of the Chat column.
- 2 Press the Send icon.

Your message will appear in the chat window in chronological order. Chat messages you've sent will be unattributed and right justified. Messages other members sent will be left justified and have their names and User icon attached to them.

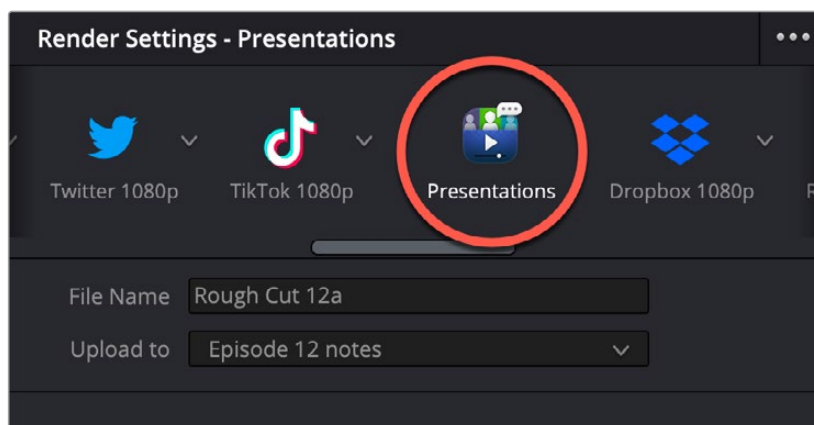
Currently, the chat is visible to all members of the presentation, and there is no way to delete a chat message once it is sent, so be kind.

Presentations in DaVinci Resolve

The Presentations application is designed to work in conjunction with DaVinci Resolve. Each “clip” in Presentations is linked to a DaVinci Resolve timeline. Any markers added by members in Presentations are updated to the timeline in DaVinci Resolve automatically and vice versa.

Sending a Timeline to Presentations

Each “clip” in Presentations is a DaVinci Resolve timeline. In order to populate the Clips column with footage to work with, you will first need to export your timeline from DaVinci Resolve to Presentations.



The Presentations Render Preset in the Deliver page.

To Send a DaVinci Resolve Timeline to Presentations:

- 1 Make sure you are signed into your Blackmagic Cloud account in the Internet Accounts section of the DaVinci Resolve Preferences.
- 2 Make sure you are a member of the presentation you wish to send the timeline to.
- 3 Open the timeline you wish to send.
- 4 In the Deliver page, select the Presentations render preset.
- 5 In the File Name field, type in a name for your timeline to appear as in Presentations.
- 6 In the Upload to field, select the presentation you wish to upload the timeline to. If the presentation is not in the list, see steps 1 and 2.
- 7 Click on the Add to Render Queue button at the bottom of the Render Settings.
- 8 Click on the Render All button under the Render Queue.

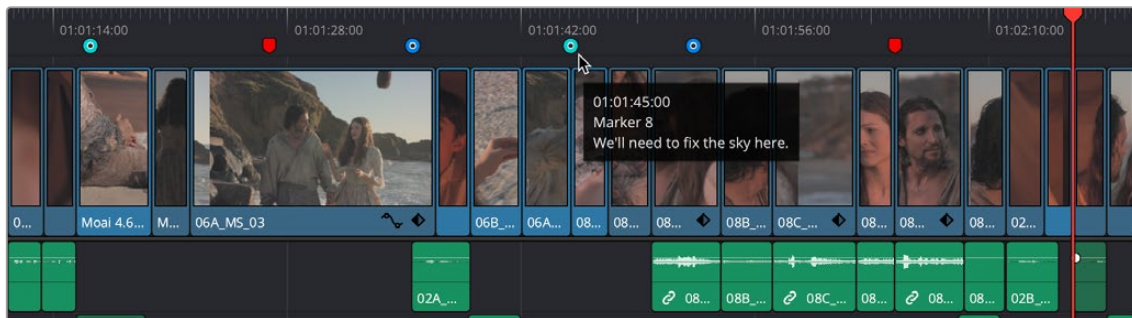
There are no video or audio codec parameters to set, and DaVinci Resolve will proceed to render your timeline and upload it automatically to the selected presentation. Any member can upload a timeline to a presentation, not just the administrator.

The timeline will now appear as a “clip” in the Clips column of the presentation.

Using Markers Between Presentations and DaVinci Resolve

A key benefit of Presentations is persistent markers between a presentation and a DaVinci Resolve timeline. Once a timeline has been uploaded to a presentation, it's automatically linked behind the scenes and any markers added, either in the Presentations app or in DaVinci Resolve, will sync with each other.

On the DaVinci Resolve side, the sync occurs when a timeline is open, and the user is logged in to the Blackmagic Cloud. For example, markers can be added by members the previous night and will then sync when the editor opens the timeline in the morning. You can also collaborate live with a presentation if the members are online and the editor is working in the timeline, updating markers in real time.



Presentations markers are circular in shape and are synced between the timeline and its associated Presentations clip.

Markers that are linked to Presentations display as circular on the DaVinci Resolve timeline to differentiate them from normal markers that are triangular in shape. Presentations Markers will also reflect the color of the member creating the marker.

Markers don't just travel one way from Presentations to DaVinci Resolve. While working on a timeline in DaVinci Resolve, the user can add special Presentations markers that will sync and show up in the Presentations application, to be viewed by all members.

To Add a Presentations marker on a DaVinci Resolve Timeline:

- 1 You must have already uploaded a timeline to Presentations as described above.
- 2 Place the playhead in the Timeline where you want the Presentations marker.
- 3 Select Mark > Add Marker > Presentations.

To Delete a Presentations marker on a DaVinci Resolve Timeline:

- 1 Select the circular Presentations marker on the Timeline.
- 2 Press the Delete key.
- 3 Click on the Delete button in the warning dialog.

Deleting a Presentations marker will remove it from both the Timeline and the presentation itself. This operation is not undoable. The timeline user is able to delete a Presentations marker from any member, not just their own.